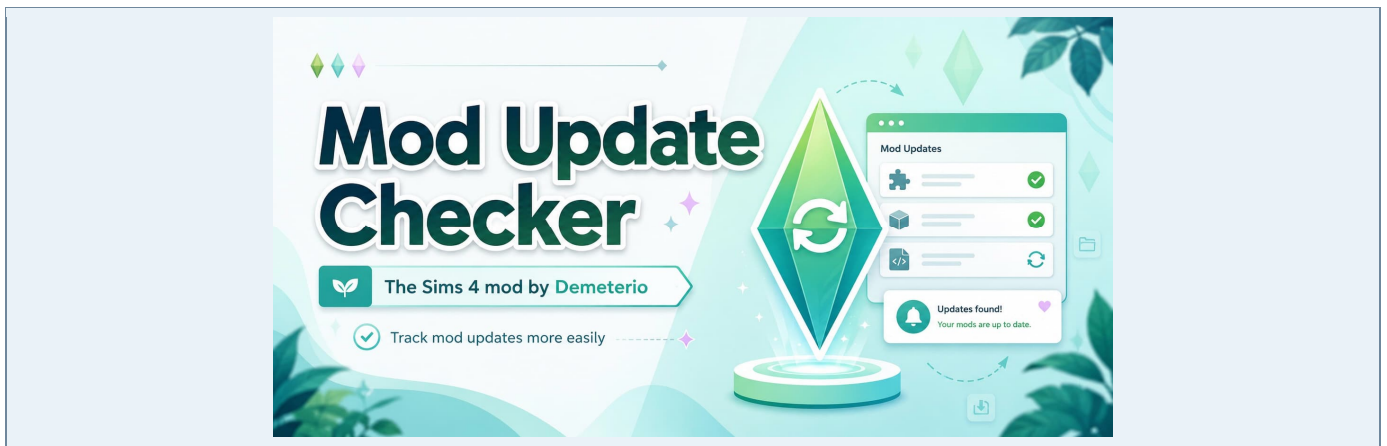


DEMETERIO'S MOD UPDATE CHECKER (MUC)

Modder Documentation



DOCUMENT INFORMATION	
Guide version	v1.1
Guide revision date	July 23, 2026
Since MUC version	1.0.1
Declaration schema	1
Registry schema	1
Language	English

VERSIONED DOCUMENTATION

Use the PDF guide and declaration template shipped in the same MODDER archive as the MUC files you install.

FUTURE TUTORIAL VIDEOS

Some future videos about each section of this guide will be released on YouTube.

Here is the link to the future playlist: <https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLVvdAOQDQJys>

Official Contacts, Downloads, and Support



OFFICIAL PROJECT

Use only the official links below. GitHub's automatically generated Source code ZIP and TAR files are not ready-to-install Sims 4 mod downloads.

Resource	Official location
Latest MUC Release (GitHub)	github.com/Demeterio/Mod-Update-Checker/releases/latest
MUC public source code	github.com/Demeterio/Mod-Update-Checker/tree/main/src
Public registry repository GitHub	github.com/Demeterio/Mod-Update-Checker_registry
Registry contribution guide	github.com/Demeterio/Mod-Update-Checker_registry/blob/main/CONTRIBUTING.md
Live registry catalogue	http://muc-registry.demeterio.cc/registry/
Creator website	demeterio.tumblr.com/
Mod The Sims creator page	modthesims.info/downloads/all/?u=10304233
Discord community	discord.gg/mPyRPSceS
Support / bug reports	Use the official Mod The Sims thread or the appropriate GitHub repository.

DOWNLOAD SAFETY

You may distribute your own declaration package. Do not mirror, rename, repackage, or silently bundle MUC's .ts4script or Generic .package. Direct players to the official MUC download links listed above.

Terminology and How-to

These terms are used throughout the guide. Read them before editing the declaration template or the registry JSON.

Term	Meaning
MUC	Mod Update Checker.
Declaration package	A small Sims 4 .package containing one ModUpdateCheckerDeclaration snippet for a compatible mod.
mod_id	The permanent identifier shared by the declaration package and registry entry.
SemVer	Semantic Versioning in MAJOR.MINOR.PATCH form, with optional prerelease and build metadata.
Release Candidate (RC)	It is a prerelease that is considered nearly ready for stable publication. If no major issue is found, the RC may become the final stable release. Typical release progression: Alpha → Beta → RC → Stable.
Installed version	The strict SemVer value shipped in the declaration package currently installed by the player.
Available version	The version resolved from a published GitHub Release and stored in the central registry.
Stable channel	A channel that compares only against stable published Releases.
Prerelease channel	A channel that may select the newer of the stable and prerelease registry entries.
Git tag	A named pointer to a repository commit, such as v1.2.0. A tag alone is not a published GitHub Release.
GitHub Release	A published GitHub object attached to a tag. The registry builder reads Release metadata, not ordinary tags.
Release asset	A manually uploaded file attached to a Release, such as the PLAYER or MODDER ZIP.
Registry entry JSON	One reviewed source file in entries/ that tells the registry builder where to resolve public versions.
Signed registry	The public JSON envelope authenticated with the MUC production signing key.
Pull Request (PR)	A proposed file change submitted from a branch or fork for automated validation and review on GitHub.
Provider	The locally declared official player-facing update page: GitHub Releases, Mod The Sims, or SimFileShare.

IMPORTANT DISTINCTION

The public registry always resolves available versions from GitHub Releases. The declaration provider controls only the official page printed for the player. A mod may therefore use GitHub Releases as its registry source while directing players to Mod The Sims or SimFileShare as downloading source.

How to Use This Guide

The numbered sections follow the complete first-time workflow. Complete Sections 1 through 5 in order. Section 6 is the shorter workflow for later versions. Use the appendices only when you need exact XML, commands, statuses, or privacy details.

NO COMMAND LINE REQUIRED

The beginner workflow uses Sims 4 Studio and the GitHub website. Git, GitHub Desktop, Visual Studio Code, and terminal commands are optional.

What you are building

MUC only checks mods whose creators include a valid declaration package in their mods. The declaration stores the installed version and official downloading page. After player consent, MUC retrieves one signed public registry (MUC registry) and compares versions locally in the player's game. If no installed mod includes a declaration, MUC has nothing to check.

HOW MUC GETS UPDATE INFORMATION

1. Declaration package in your mod -> installed_version, channel, and official download page.
2. Your public GitHub Releases -> published stable and/or prerelease versions.
3. The public Demeterio's MUC registry checks those Releases daily and publishes one signed registry.
4. MUC verifies that registry, compares versions locally, and writes the player report.

PUBLIC CATALOGUE

Every registered mod is visible at <http://muc-registry.demeterio.cc/registry/>

First-time workflow

#	Action	You finish with	Read
1	Prepare MUC and the declaration template	Development files are ready.	Section 1
2	Create and test the declaration package	MUC registers your exact local version.	Section 2
3	Create a free GitHub account and your own public mod repository	You have a public version source.	Section 3
4	Publish the first GitHub Release	The registry can resolve a stable or prerelease version.	Section 4
5	Add one JSON entry to the public MUC registry and open a Pull Request	Validation and Demeterio review begin.	Section 5
6	After merge, test the full workflow and optionally delete the fork	The signed registry works in game.	Section 5
7	Publish future versions with the short workflow	Normal updates no longer need a registry PR.	Section 6

Before you begin

- Your mod project and a version you can test.
- The current MUC MODDER ZIP and Sims 4 Studio.
- A disposable test save for The Sims 4.
- A free GitHub account, unless you already have one.
- A public page identifying the mod and creator.

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1. Prepare MUC for Development

1.1 Download the correct archive

Use one of the official MUC download pages listed at the beginning of this guide. Choose the PLAYER ZIP for a normal installation or the MODDER ZIP when creating or testing a declaration package. On GitHub, download the attached Release asset; do not use the automatic Source code ZIP or TAR archive.

The MODDER ZIP includes the current MUC files, this guide, and the declaration template package. Keep every file from the same MUC Release together.

1.2 Extract and install the development files

1. Extract the MODDER ZIP to a normal project folder outside Documents/Electronic Arts/The Sims 4/Mods.
2. Keep the PDF guide and untouched declaration template in that project folder.
3. Copy only the current MUC .ts4script and Generic .package into your Mods folder.
4. Keep the .ts4script no more than one folder below Mods.
5. Remove older MUC .ts4script and Generic .package copies before testing.
6. Enable Custom Content and Mods and Script Mods Allowed in Game Options.
7. Delete localthumbcache.package after changing package or script files.
8. Restart the game completely and answer the MUC network-consent dialog.

```
Documents/Electronic Arts/The Sims 4/Mods/  
└─ Demeterio_ModUpdateChecker/  
   └─ Demeterio_ModUpdateChecker_Script_vX.ts4script  
      └─ Demeterio_ModUpdateChecker_Generic_vX.package
```

DO NOT INSTALL THE UNCHANGED TEMPLATE

The template is a development starting point. Copy it into your own project folder, rename it, replace every placeholder, and assign new resource identifiers (tuning ID hash) before installing or distributing the finished declaration package.

SECTION CHECKPOINT

MUC loads in game, both MUC files come from the same Release, and the untouched template remains outside the Mods folder.

2. Create and Test the Declaration Package

2.1 Copy and rename the template

1. Copy the declaration template package from the MODDER archive into your own mod project folder.
2. Rename the copy with your creator name, mod name, and version.
3. Open the copied package in Sims 4 Studio.

Recommended package name: CreatorName_ModName_ModUpdateChecker_vX.Y.Z.package
Recommended tuning name: CreatorName:ModName_ModUpdateChecker_Declaration

2.2 Create the tuning ID and permanent mod_id

Create two different identifiers and keep both in your project notes:

Identifier	Used for	Rule
Tuning instance ID	The snippet resource inside the .package.	Generate a new unique tuning instance ID in Sims 4 Studio and use it for the resource instance and XML 's' value. Recommended hash from the tuning name.
mod_id	The same mod across package versions and the public registry.	Use creator.mod_name followed by a dot and one permanent 16-character uppercase FNV64 hash.

Recommended source-string pattern for the mod_id hash: creator:mod_name:modupdatechecker
Required mod_id format: creator.mod_name.0123456789ABCDEF
Registry filename later: <exact mod_id>.json

1. Generate a new unique tuning instance ID for the snippet resource in Sims 4 Studio.
2. For the public mod_id, choose lowercase creator and mod_name segments. Use only ASCII letters, digits, underscores, or hyphens.
3. Open Tools > Hash Generator in Sims 4 Studio, select FNV64, and enter one stable source string for the mod identity. See above "Recommended source-string pattern for the mod_id hash".
4. Copy the 16-character hexadecimal FNV64 result, write it in uppercase, and append it after creator.mod_name.
5. Record the source string, FNV64 result, tuning name, tuning instance ID, and final mod_id. Do not change the mod_id for ordinary updates, renames, repository moves, or provider changes.

TWO DIFFERENT IDENTIFIERS

The tuning instance ID identifies the XML resource inside the package. The mod_id identifies the mod in MUC and the public registry. They are not interchangeable.

2.3 Choose your current mod installed_version and release_channel

installed_version uses strict Semantic Versioning without a leading 'v':

Required installed_version format: MAJOR.MINOR.PATCH[-PRERELEASE][+BUILD]

Use 1.0.0 for a stable version. Use 1.1.0-beta.1 for a prerelease. The leading 'v' belongs only to the GitHub tag, such as v1.0.0.

VALID EXAMPLES

1.0.0 0.0.1 1.2.0-beta.1 2.0.0-rc.2+build.17

INVALID EXAMPLES

v1.0.0 1.0 1.0.0.0 01.0.0 1.0.0-beta.01 1.0.0 beta

Channel	Use it when	MUC compares against
stable	Players should receive normal stable Releases only.	The stable registry entry.
prerelease	Testers may receive alpha, beta, or RC builds.	The newer allowed stable or prerelease entry.

TYPICAL PROGRESSION

Alpha -> Beta -> Release Candidate (RC) -> Stable.

A stable version is newer than a prerelease with the same MAJOR.MINOR.PATCH values.

2.4 Choose the official download page

Choose exactly one `download_page_provider`. The provider controls the Official update page printed in the local report; it does not change the GitHub Releases source used by the MUC registry.

GitHub Releases provider

XML field	Value
<code>download_page_provider</code>	GITHUB_RELEASE
<code>github_download_owner</code>	Your GitHub account or organization name.
<code>github_download_repository</code>	Your public mod repository name.
Remove	<code>mod_the_sims_submission_id</code> and <code>sim_file_share_folder_id</code> .

Mod The Sims provider

XML field	Value
<code>download_page_provider</code>	MOD_THE_SIMS
<code>mod_the_sims_submission_id</code>	The positive numeric submission ID.
Remove	GitHub provider fields and <code>sim_file_share_folder_id</code> .

SimFileShare provider

XML field	Value
<code>download_page_provider</code>	SIM_FILE_SHARE
<code>sim_file_share_folder_id</code>	The positive numeric folder ID.
Remove	GitHub provider fields and <code>mod_the_sims_submission_id</code> .

2.5 Short procedure reminder in Sims 4 Studio

1. Rename the snippet tuning using your creator and mod name.
2. Assign a new unique tuning instance ID and update both the package resource instance and the decimal 's' value in the XML.
3. Replace the template `mod_id` with the permanent value you recorded.
4. Set `mod_name` to the player-facing name.
5. Set `installed_version` to the exact version included in this mod archive.
6. Set `release_channel` to stable or prerelease.
7. Set one `download_page_provider` and keep only its required fields.
8. Remove every placeholder and every field belonging to another provider.

9. Save the package, close Sims 4 Studio, reopen the package, and confirm the XML is still correct.

COMPLETE XML EXAMPLES

Use Appendix A and copy only the example matching your provider. The public class is `ModUpdateCheckerDeclaration` in module `mod_update_checker.tuning`.

2.6 Test local registration before using GitHub

1. Install the current MUC .ts4script and Generic .package.
2. Install one copy of your completed declaration package.
3. Delete `localthumbcache.package`.
4. Launch The Sims 4 and load a disposable save.
5. Open the cheat console with `Ctrl + Shift + C`.
6. Run `demeterio.muc_version`, then `demeterio.muc_getlist`, then `demeterio.muc_openlog`.
7. Confirm the exact mod name, `mod_id`, installed version, release channel, and alert state in the log.

EXPECTED BEFORE REGISTRY PUBLICATION

A valid declaration can register before its public entry exists. After a check, `REGISTRY_MISSING` is an expected transitional result: the local package works, but the signed registry does not list the mod yet.

STOP WHEN REGISTRATION FAILS

Read the first declaration error in `demeterio_modupdatechecker_log.txt`, correct the package, and repeat this test before creating the GitHub Release or registry entry.

2.7 Distribute your declaration and explain the MUC dependency

Distribution model	Advantage	Important consideration
Inside the main mod package	Always matches the installed mod version.	Rebuild the package for every mod release.
Separate required package	Keeps integration metadata separate.	Players may accidentally keep an older declaration.
Separate optional package	Players choose whether to use MUC.	Instructions must clearly explain version matching.

SUGGESTED PLAYER TEXT

"This mod includes a Mod Update Checker declaration package. To receive update reports, download the latest MUC PLAYER release separately from an official MUC page. When updating this mod, remove the previous files and install the complete new version so the declared installed version remains accurate."

DO NOT BUNDLE MUC

You may distribute your own declaration package.

Do not silently include, mirror, rename, or repackage MUC's .ts4script or Generic .package.

Direct players to the official MUC download links listed at the beginning of this guide.

SECTION CHECKPOINT

The declaration contains no placeholders, uses one permanent `mod_id`, has the correct installed version and provider fields, and registers successfully in the MUC log.

3. Create Your GitHub Account and Mod Repository

3.1 Create a free GitHub account

Skip this subsection when you already have a suitable account.

1. Open GitHub and choose Sign up.
2. Create a free personal account with an email address and public username, or use a supported social sign-in option.
3. Verify the email address. GitHub requires a verified address for basic tasks such as creating a repository.
4. Sign in and enable two-factor authentication when possible.

Sign-up page: <https://github.com/signup>

YOUR USERNAME IS PUBLIC

Your username appears on repositories, Releases, forks, commits, Pull Requests, and comments. Use the account that should publicly maintain the mod.

3.2 Understand repository, Release, and download asset

The public MUC registry at github.com/Demeterio/Mod-Update-Checker_registry reads the published GitHub Releases from your own public mod repository. It uses those Releases to resolve available versions; the declaration package still controls the official download page shown to players.

GitHub item	What it is	How MUC uses it
Repository	The public project space under your account.	The public MUC registry records which repository contains the mod Releases.
GitHub Release	A published version page attached to a Git tag.	The registry reads the version tag and stable/prerelease flag.
Release asset	A ZIP or other file manually attached to the Release.	Optional for registry resolution; useful when players download from GitHub.
Source code ZIP/TAR	Automatic archives of repository source.	Not a ready-to-install Sims 4 mod archive.

YOUR REPOSITORY CAN STAY SIMPLE

README.md and published Releases are enough for registry use. For script mods, publishing versioned source under src/ is recommended for transparency and independent review by players, modders, and security-tool authors, but it is not required by MUC.

3.3 Create the public mod repository

1. In the upper-right corner of GitHub, open the + menu and choose New repository.
2. Choose your personal account or organization as the owner.
3. Enter a clear repository name and short description.
4. Choose Public. A private repository cannot be used by the public registry.
5. Enable Add a README file so the repository has its first commit.
6. Optionally choose a license or add a permissions notice later.
7. Click Create repository.

README.md	minimum recommended start
src/	optional script source
docs/	optional documentation
.github/	optional templates and automation

3.4 Review simple repository options

Option	Beginner recommendation
Issues	Keep enabled only when you want bug reports on GitHub. Otherwise, Settings > General > Features > clear Issues.
Discussions	Leave disabled unless you want a public question-and-answer area.
Wiki	Optional. A README is enough for a simple mod repository.
Release immutability	Recommended for release integrity when you are ready to publish corrections under a new version and tag.

WHAT IMMUTABLE RELEASES PREVENT

After an immutable Release is published, only description text can be edited. Its attached files cannot be modified or deleted and its tag cannot be moved. Prepare the Release as a draft, attach every final file, then publish. Fix mistakes with a new patch version instead of replacing files under the same tag.

[Read GitHub documentation](#)

3.5 Add the essential README information

- Mod name and creator.
- A short explanation of what the mod does.
- Official player download page.
- Installation requirements and dependencies.
- MUC dependency notice when applicable.
- Permissions or license.

SECTION CHECKPOINT

The GitHub account is verified, the repository is public, README.md exists, and the repository options match how you want to support players.

4. Publish the First GitHub Release

4.1 Publish a stable Release

1. Open the main page of your public mod repository.
2. To the right of the file list, click Releases. If no Release exists yet, GitHub may also show Create a new release.
3. Click Draft a new release.
4. Open Choose a tag. Type a tag such as v1.0.0 and create it on the repository default branch or the commit containing this version.
5. Enter a clear Release title and short player-facing notes.
6. Attach the final mod ZIP when GitHub is a player download location.
7. Leave Set as a pre-release unchecked for a stable version.
8. Review the tag, notes, assets, and channel option.
9. Click Publish release. Save draft is not enough for the registry.

Declaration .package	GitHub Release
installed_version = 1.0.0	tag = v1.0.0; prerelease option OFF
release_channel = stable	published Release, not a draft

WHEN PLAYERS DOWNLOAD ELSEWHERE

The registry still needs a public GitHub Release when players download from Mod The Sims or SimFileShare. In that case, a GitHub asset is optional; the Release provides public version metadata while the declaration generated the real download page in the report.

4.2 Publish a prerelease

Use the same procedure with a prerelease SemVer tag, such as v1.1.0-beta.1, and enable Set as a pre-release before publishing.

Declaration .package	GitHub Release
installed_version = 1.1.0-beta.1	tag = v1.1.0-beta.1; prerelease option ON
release_channel = prerelease	published Release, not a draft

4.3 Verify the Release before creating the registry entry

- Open the Release while signed out or in a private browser window.
- Confirm it appears in the repository Releases list.
- Confirm the text after the configured tag prefix is strict SemVer.
- Confirm the Release is not a draft.
- Confirm the prerelease option matches the intended channel.
- Confirm attached mod ZIP files are the final files when Releases are immutable.

DO NOT REUSE VERSIONS

Do not distribute different files under the same installed_version and Git tag. Publish corrections under a new patch version, such as 1.0.1.

SECTION CHECKPOINT

The public repository contains at least one matching published Release that is visible while signed out.

5. Add Your Mod to the Public MUC Registry

You will create one JSON source file in a temporary fork of Demeterio's public registry, commit it, and open a Pull Request. The current CONTRIBUTING guide remains the authority for the exact submission form and validation rules. After the entry is merged and published, the mod appears in the public catalogue at <http://muc-registry.demeterio.cc/registry/>.

Use	Official link
Registry repository	Open Demeterio/Mod-Update-Checker_registry
Browser-only contribution guide	Read CONTRIBUTING.md
Current JSON entry template	Open mod-entry.template.json

5.1 Check that the setup is ready

- The declaration package registers locally.
- The permanent mod_id is final and recorded.
- Your GitHub mod repository is public.
- At least one matching published, non-draft Release exists.
- The official presentation mod page is public over HTTPS.
- You are the creator, maintainer, or authorized representative.

5.2 Fork the registry

1. Sign in to the GitHub account that will maintain the entry.
2. Open Demeterio/Mod-Update-Checker_registry.
3. Click Fork near the top-right corner.
4. Keep the suggested repository name and click Create fork.

WHAT THE FORK IS

The fork is a temporary personal copy of the MUC registry repository. Edit the fork, not Demeterio's main branch. Your own mod repository is separate and must remain available after the registry entry is accepted.

5.3 Create the one JSON entry file

1. In your fork, open the entries/ folder.
2. Click Add file, then Create new file.
3. Enter the exact filename <mod_id>.json.
4. Open the current entry template in another browser tab.
5. Copy the complete template, paste it into the new file, and replace the placeholders.

```
entries/creator.mod_name.0123456789ABCDEF.json
```

Field to edit	What to enter and why
mod_id	The exact permanent mod_id from the declaration package. The filename must match it.
display_name	The public mod name.
creator_name	The public creator or team name.
mod_page	A public HTTPS page that identifies the mod and creator for verification.
maintainers	Authorized GitHub usernames, written in lowercase.
source.repository	Your public mod repository in Owner/Repository form, not a full URL.
source.tag_prefix	Usually 'v' when tags look like v1.0.0; use an empty string when tags look like 1.0.0.

Field to edit	What to enter and why
source.channels	stable, prerelease, or both, written in exact lowercase.

FIELDS YOU NORMALLY DO NOT CHANGE

Keep \$schema, schema, and source.type exactly as shown in the current template.

A normal contribution creates only your one file inside entries/.

Do not edit generated, security, schema, workflow, or tooling files.

5.4 Commit the file and open the Pull Request

1. Click Commit changes.
2. Use a short message such as Add My Mod registry entry.
3. When offered, create a new branch for the commit, such as add-my-mod, and start a Pull Request.
4. Use the Compare & pull request banner or Contribute > Open pull request.
5. Confirm the base repository is Demeterio/Mod-Update-Checker_registry, the base branch is main, and the compare branch contains your JSON file.
6. Confirm the JSON appears under Files changed.
7. Complete the Pull Request form and create the Pull Request.

```
base repository: Demeterio/Mod-Update-Checker_registry
base branch: main
head repository: your fork
compare branch: the branch containing your JSON file
```

THERE IS NOTHING TO COMPARE

Do not begin from Pull requests > New pull request before creating and committing the JSON file. If GitHub shows this message, return to the fork and verify that the file exists, the change was committed, and the correct base and compare branches are selected.

DRAFT PULL REQUEST

After the first committed difference exists, you may open a Draft Pull Request and add context before the entry is ready for final review.

5.5 Validation, corrections, and merge

- GitHub may wait for Demeterio to approve the external workflow run.
- The workflow validates the JSON and checks your public GitHub Releases.
- When a job fails, read the first ERROR line.
- Fix the JSON or public Release, then commit to the same branch. The existing Pull Request updates automatically.
- Do not close and recreate the Pull Request unless the branch comparison itself is wrong.
- The Pull Request is merged only after validation and Demeterio's review.

5.6 Test after the registry is published

1. Wait until the Pull Request is merged.
2. Wait for the signed registry publication workflow to complete.
3. Launch The Sims 4 with the same declaration package.
4. Run demeterio.muc_check.
5. Run demeterio.muc_getlist or demeterio.muc_openreport after the check completes.

6. Confirm the available version, Release tag, channel, and Official update page.

Installed version	Registry version	Expected result
1.0.0	1.0.0	UP_TO_DATE
1.0.0	1.0.1	UPDATE_AVAILABLE
1.1.0	1.0.1	UP_TO_DATE
1.1.0-beta.1 / prerelease	1.1.0 stable	UPDATE_AVAILABLE
1.1.0 / stable	1.2.0-beta.1 prerelease	Stable stays on stable; prerelease may update.

5.7 Optionally delete the temporary registry fork

WAIT UNTIL SUCCESS IS CONFIRMED

Do not delete the fork before the Pull Request is merged and the published registry has been tested. Deleting your fork does not delete Demeterio's upstream registry or the merged entry.

1. Open your fork of Mod-Update-Checker_registry.
2. Open Settings. On the General page, scroll to Danger Zone.
3. Choose Delete this repository.
4. Read GitHub's warnings, confirm the repository name, and complete the deletion.

DELETE ONLY THE TEMPORARY FORK

Deleting the fork is optional. Do not delete your own mod repository or its Releases: the registry still uses them for version checks. Keep the fork when you expect another configuration change soon; otherwise you can create a new fork later. [Read GitHub deletion instructions](#)

SECTION CHECKPOINT

The Pull Request is merged, the signed registry resolves your Release in game, and the temporary fork has been kept or deleted intentionally.

6. Publish Future Versions

The GitHub account, public mod repository, registry entry, and first Pull Request are one-time setup. Ordinary future versions use this shorter cycle.

1. In your declaration .package, keep schema_version and mod_id unchanged.
2. Update installed_version in the declaration package to the exact new SemVer.
3. Rebuild and test the declaration package.
4. Publish a new GitHub Release with the matching tag and correct stable/prerelease option.
5. Distribute the complete new mod version and remove old files from the archive.
6. Run a manual MUC check after the registry refresh.

NO NEW REGISTRY PR FOR ORDINARY RELEASES

The registry checks configured public GitHub Releases once each day. Open a new registry Pull Request only when the repository, tag prefix, channels, maintainers, mod page, or identity configuration changes.

6.1 Stable and prerelease reminders

Distribution	Declaration version/channel	GitHub Release
Stable	1.2.0 / stable	v1.2.0, prerelease option OFF
Alpha, beta, or RC	1.3.0-beta.1 / prerelease	v1.3.0-beta.1, prerelease option ON

VERSION CONTINUITY

Never change mod_id for ordinary updates, a mod rename, a repository move, or a new download page. Update the public registry configuration instead when a repository, channel, maintainer, or mod page changes.

7. Troubleshooting

FIRST STEP EVERY TIME

Open demeterio_modupdatechecker_log.txt and correct the first exact rejected condition instead of guessing.

Problem	First checks
Declaration does not register	Class/module header, tuning ID, required fields, exact strings, SemVer, provider fields, and MUC version.
Invalid mod_id	Lowercase creator/mod segments plus exactly 16 uppercase hexadecimal characters.
Identical duplicate	Two identical copies are installed. Remove one.
Conflict	Different declarations use the same mod_id. Remove old or mismatched copies.
Provider page unavailable	Provider constant and required owner/repository, submission ID, or folder ID.
No matching stable Release	Public repository, published non-draft Release, prerelease option off, prefix, and stable SemVer.
No matching prerelease Release	Prerelease option on, matching prefix, and valid prerelease SemVer.
There is nothing to compare	Commit the JSON in the fork first; verify base/head repositories and branches.
Workflow waiting	Demeterio may need to approve the external workflow run.
REGISTRY_MISSING before merge	Expected transitional state when the local declaration is valid.
REGISTRY_MISSING after merge	Confirm signed publication, exact mod_id/channel, then run a manual check.
UP_TO_DATE when update expected	Compare exact SemVer values and confirm the resolved Release tag.
Release visible by direct URL but not listed	Preserve the tag, recreate only the Release object from that tag, publish again, and rerun validation.
Network blocked	Review the versioned compatibility file. MUC does not bypass privacy or security tools.

7.1 Useful bug report contents

- The Sims 4 game version and MUC Release version.
- The complete technical log and update report.
- lastException.txt or lastUIException.txt when present.
- The declaration XML, package filename, mod_id, installed_version, channel, and provider.
- The public Release tag and registry entry or Pull Request.
- The other privacy or security tool name and version when relevant.
- Clear reproduction steps on a disposable save.

DO NOT WEAKEN VERIFICATION

A malformed, stale, rolled-back, or incorrectly signed registry must be rejected. Treat it as a publication, clock, or network problem; do not remove signature or freshness checks.

Appendix A - Complete Declaration XML Examples

Replace every placeholder. Keep the permanent mod_id. Use only the example matching the selected provider.

A.1 GitHub Releases - stable

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="utf-8"?>
<I c="ModUpdateCheckerDeclaration" i="snippet"
  m="mod_update_checker.tuning"
  n="CreatorName:ModName_ModUpdateChecker_Declaration"
  s="YOUR_UNIQUE_DECIMAL_TUNING_ID">
  <T n="schema_version">1</T>
  <T n="mod_id">creator.mod_name.0123456789ABCDEF</T>
  <T n="mod_name">Mod Name</T>
  <T n="installed_version">1.0.0</T>
  <T n="release_channel">stable</T>
  <T n="download_page_provider">GITHUB_RELEASE</T>
  <T n="github_download_owner">GitHubOwner</T>
  <T n="github_download_repository">RepositoryName</T>
</I>
```

GENERATED LINK IN THE REPORT

MUC builds <https://github.com/GitHubOwner/RepositoryName/releases/latest>

A.2 GitHub Releases - prerelease

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="utf-8"?>
<I c="ModUpdateCheckerDeclaration" i="snippet"
  m="mod_update_checker.tuning"
  n="CreatorName:ModName_ModUpdateChecker_Declaration"
  s="YOUR_UNIQUE_DECIMAL_TUNING_ID">
  <T n="schema_version">1</T>
  <T n="mod_id">creator.mod_name.0123456789ABCDEF</T>
  <T n="mod_name">Mod Name</T>
  <T n="installed_version">1.1.0-beta.1</T>
  <T n="release_channel">prerelease</T>
  <T n="download_page_provider">GITHUB_RELEASE</T>
  <T n="github_download_owner">GitHubOwner</T>
  <T n="github_download_repository">RepositoryName</T>
</I>
```

GENERATED LINK IN THE REPORT

MUC builds <https://github.com/GitHubOwner/RepositoryName/releases/latest>

A.3 Mod The Sims update page

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="utf-8"?>
<I c="ModUpdateCheckerDeclaration" i="snippet"
  m="mod_update_checker.tuning"
  n="CreatorName:ModName_ModUpdateChecker_Declaration"
  s="YOUR_UNIQUE_DECIMAL_TUNING_ID">
  <T n="schema_version">1</T>
  <T n="mod_id">creator.mod_name.0123456789ABCDEF</T>
  <T n="mod_name">Mod Name</T>
  <T n="installed_version">1.0.0</T>
  <T n="release_channel">stable</T>
  <T n="download_page_provider">MOD_THE_SIMS</T>
  <T n="mod_the_sims_submission_id">123456</T>
</I>
```

GENERATED LINK IN THE REPORT

MUC builds <https://modthesims.info/d/123456> from the positive submission ID.

A.4 SimFileShare update page

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="utf-8"?>
<I c="ModUpdateCheckerDeclaration" i="snippet"
  m="mod_update_checker.tuning"
  n="CreatorName:ModName_ModUpdateChecker_Declaration"
  s="YOUR_UNIQUE_DECIMAL_TUNING_ID">
  <T n="schema_version">1</T>
  <T n="mod_id">creator.mod_name.0123456789ABCDEF</T>
  <T n="mod_name">Mod Name</T>
  <T n="installed_version">1.0.0</T>
  <T n="release_channel">stable</T>
  <T n="download_page_provider">SIM_FILE_SHARE</T>
  <T n="sim_file_share_folder_id">123456</T>
</I>
```

GENERATED LINK IN THE REPORT

MUC builds <https://simfileshare.net/folder/123456/> from the positive folder ID.

Appendix B - Commands, Statuses, and Local Files

B.1 Commands

Command	Purpose
demeterio.muc_version	Show the MUC version and registered-mod count.
demeterio.muc_getlist	Write declaration and scheduler information to the technical log.
demeterio.muc_check	Request a manual registry check.
demeterio.muc_settings	Open network and notification settings.
demeterio.muc_alerton *	Enable summaries for all registered mods.
demeterio.muc_alertoff *	Disable summaries for all registered mods.
demeterio.muc_alerton <mod_id>	Enable summaries for one exact mod_id.
demeterio.muc_alertoff <mod_id>	Disable summaries for one exact mod_id.
demeterio.muc_openreport	Open the player report.
demeterio.muc_openlog	Open the technical log.
demeterio.muc_openlogfolder	Open the writable-file folder.

TESTING CHEATS

These commands do not require 'testingcheats on'.

B.2 Runtime statuses

Status	Meaning
NOT_CHECKED	No usable registry result has been applied yet.
UP_TO_DATE	The available version is not newer than installed_version.
UPDATE_AVAILABLE	The available version is newer than installed_version.
REGISTRY_MISSING	No usable current entry exists for the selected mod and channel.
CHECK_ERROR	A check or declaration-specific operation failed.
CONFLICT	Different declarations used the same mod_id and were blocked.

B.3 Writable files

File	Purpose
demeterio_modupdatechecker_log.txt	Technical registration, checks, commands, warnings, and errors.
demeterio_modupdatechecker_log.txt.1	One rotated backup when the active log reaches its size limit.
demeterio_modupdatechecker_updates.txt	Player report replaced after each completed check.
demeterio_modupdatechecker_settings.dmuc	Local network and notification preferences.
demeterio_modupdatechecker_cache.dmuc	Local check, version, notification, and registry freshness data.

LOCAL ONLY

These files remain on the player's computer and are not uploaded by MUC.

Appendix C - Privacy, Security, and Compatibility Summary

After player consent, MUC makes one fixed request for public version metadata:

```
http://muc-registry.demeterio.cc/generated/registry-v1.json
```

A normal request may expose	MUC does not send
Public IP address; request date and time; fixed path; MUC User-Agent.	EA account name; local computer username; Mods folder contents; installed mod list or versions; save or gameplay data; analytics; cookies; credentials.

The Sims 4 Python runtime does not include the native `_ssl` extension required by Python's standard SSL module. MUC therefore uses this dedicated HTTP endpoint and verifies the signed document before applying any data.

- MUC verifies an RS256 signature before parsing the registry and rejects malformed, modified, stale (more than seven days old), future-dated (more than six hours), or rolled-back documents.
- Only `muc-registry.demeterio.cc` on port 80 and the exact registry path are accepted. Alternate hosts, ports, paths, credentials, query strings, fragments, redirects, compressed or oversized responses, and non-JSON responses are rejected.
- MUC does not bypass ModGuard, Privacy Protector, firewalls, antivirus software, or operating-system protections. A blocked or rejected check stops safely and normal gameplay continues.
- For complete tested compatibility notes and reporting instructions, read the versioned Compatibility text from the same MUC Release. The public MUC source and registry project are available for independent inspection.

USE THE CURRENT COMPATIBILITY FILE

Read `Demeterio_ModUpdateChecker_Compatibility_vX.txt` from the same PLAYER or MODDER Release as the installed MUC version. Use the official download links listed at the beginning of this guide.

References and Project Resources

Resource	Link
Latest MUC Release	Download the current PLAYER or MODDER asset
MUC public source	Inspect the Python source and project files
Registry repository	Open the public registry
Registry contribution guide	Read the current browser-only instructions
Registry JSON template	Open the current entry template
Public catalogue	Browse registered mods
GitHub account documentation	Creating an account on GitHub
GitHub repository documentation	Creating a new repository
GitHub Release documentation	Managing Releases in a repository
GitHub immutable Releases	Learn what immutable Releases protect
GitHub fork deletion	Deleting a repository or fork
Sims 4 Studio	Open Sims 4 Studio

Guide Changelog

Guide version	Changes
2026-07-23 – v1.1	Initial complete modder documentation.

Final Contacts, Credits, Copyright, and Disclaimer

Contact	Information
Creator	Demeterio
Website / Tumblr	demeterio.tumblr.com/
Discord	discord.gg/mPyRPSdgeS
MUC repository	github.com/Demeterio/Mod-Update-Checker
Registry repository	github.com/Demeterio/Mod-Update-Checker_registry
Mod The Sims	modthesims.info/downloads/all/?u=10304233

Credits

Mod Update Checker, its original documentation, tuning examples, registry design, and supporting materials are created by Demeterio. Community tools and reference resources remain the property of their respective authors.

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